School Closure Report

Lewis Elementary School

Date: 11/17/2026

School Closure Process
The PPS Board of Education determines whether schools will be closed. Board determination on school closures is based on the Superintendent's recommendation. The School Initiation & Closure policy (6.10.030-P) requires that the Superintendent's recommendation be accompanied by a School Closure Report.

If you have questions about this process or this report, please contact:

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501 N Dixon, Portland, OR 97227 | 503-916-2000

1. School Profile

School Name
Meriwether Lewis Elementary School

Administrator
Anna Davis

Location
4401 SE Evergreen St, Portland OR

Grade levels served
K-5

1a. School Description

Meriwether Lewis Elementary School is a K–5 neighborhood school in Southeast Portland's Woodstock neighborhood. It hosts a focus on literacy and mathematics, additional reading and mathematics support, visual arts, gardens, physical education, and library services. The school has 19 classrooms in a single-story campus with gardens supporting environmental education. Approximately 240 students are enrolled at Lewis for the 2026-2027 school year.

1b. Financial Impact

The primary financial benefit of consolidating elementary schools and programs is to align school capacity and operating costs with enrollment, allowing PPS to concentrate limited resources in fewer, more efficiently resourced schools. Combining school communities can reduce duplicative school-level administrative and operating expenses, improve building utilization, and support more efficient staffing and program delivery. These consolidations are intended to generate ongoing savings while supporting strong core instructional programs and student services.

If the school remains open, the projected cost per student for the 2028-2029 school year is: $19,094. (This is calculated using projected FY28 compensation levels and current staffing practices, which could change in the near future due to budget uncertainty.)

If the school is closed in 2028, the projected overall savings is $860,366. This includes savings from administrative, custodial, and office staffing, 80% of utilities, and includes the one-time cost of teacher moves. We anticipate ongoing expenses, including 20% of current utility costs and an average annual security cost, if the school were closed and unoccupied.

To accommodate students who live more than one mile from Duniway, PPS anticipates maintaining service to Duniway with two buses. The Transportation Department estimates an additional savings of approximately $122,000. The proposed change would reduce the total number of buses serving the closing and receiving schools, resulting in transportation cost savings.

Transportation and Safe Routes to School planning will identify needed supports for safe arrival and dismissal, including walking and biking improvements, crossing supports, or traffic circulation changes.

1c. Student Enrollment

Table 1. Projected enrollment over the next five years, if school remains open:

School Year	2027-28	2028-29	2029-30	2030-31	2031-32
Students Enrolled	224	206	213	202	201

History of Requested and Actual Transfers
During 2024-2025, 2025-2026, and 2026-2027 school years, 67 students requested transfers into Lewis and 22 enrolled through an approved transfer. During the same period, 104 students residing within the school's attendance area requested transfers to other schools, and 26 enrolled elsewhere through an approved transfer.

Projected declining enrollment will make it difficult to maintain stable staffing, full programming, and essential student support services. Under enrollment-based staffing allocations, low enrollment can result in year-to-year staffing changes, blended-grade classrooms or combined programs, and reduced access to enrichment and student support offerings. Staff may serve multiple roles or split time across schools, limiting continuity and availability. While educators would continue working to meet students' needs, projected enrollment would constrain the school's ability to provide consistent access to a well-rounded educational experience without ongoing supplemental district resources.

2. School Facilities and Student Reassignment

2a. School Description

Built	Building size	Stories	Acres
1952	47,389 sq ft	1	5.45
Building condition	**Gross capacity**	**Functional capacity**	**Cost of school operations**
Poor; FCI 0.2	540 students	420 students	$3,933,404

Gross capacity is the estimated maximum number of students a school can accommodate, calculated by assigning a student capacity to each classroom based on its square footage and summing those capacities:

- Less than 800 square feet: 24 students
- 800–1,000 square feet: 27 students
- More than 1,000 square feet: 30 students

Functional capacity is a practical estimate of the number of students a school can accommodate, calculated by multiplying its gross capacity by the applicable utilization rate. It does not represent maximum occupancy under building code requirements or determine

staffing levels.

The cost of school operations includes projected FY28 school-based costs in funds 100 and 200 plus Facilities, Nutrition Services, and Special Education, at the current service level.

Physical Condition of Building, Capital and Environmental Needs
Lewis a single-story, L-shaped wood-frame school with brick, wood, and concrete-block cladding and interconnected wings under shed and gable roofs. Previous facility assessments conducted in 2019–2020 identified temperature-control problems in the north addition, original boilers with reported piping leaks, cracking around the gym's exterior brick wall, weathered window frames and cracked panes, and damaged exterior metal doors. In addition, it identified undersized kindergarten, special education, library, gymnasium, and cafeteria spaces. Lewis received a seismic retrofit in 2018.

ADA Accessibility
Lewis has an accessible main entrance and is a single story building.

Building Use
Lewis houses a K–5 neighborhood school and Communication Behavior classrooms, with music, visual arts, physical education, library, and garden-based learning opportunities

Analysis of current and potential use of the facility, including recommended disposition
Following closure, potential uses of the Lewis facility will be evaluated through the district's Building Repurposing process, informed by community engagement, district needs, facility conditions, and financial considerations. This process will consider opportunities to support students and the surrounding community and identify a recommended future use or disposition for Board consideration. The 2018 SRGP seismic grant requires Lewis to be used for educational purposes for 10 years. Because the school isn't set to close until 2028, that 10-year requirement will be fulfilled.

2b. Student Reassignment

The proposed closure of Lewis Elementary School would reassign neighborhood K–5 students to Duniway. Students served in Lewis Communication Behavior classrooms would also receive services at Duniway.

Proposed Attendance Boundary
See attached map.

Transportation options and barriers
Transportation options include walking, biking, family transportation, and school bus service for elementary students who live more than one mile from their neighborhood school; additional students may qualify based on Oregon Department of Education guidelines or individual needs. We do not anticipate any barriers to students getting to school; however, additional bussing may be provided, as needed, for hazard areas within the school attendance boundary.

How will this school location accommodate the reassigned students?
Duniway has 25 classrooms and a functional capacity of 552 students. With a combined enrollment of 533, Duniway will be able to accommodate the reassigned students.

Recommendation
PPS recommends closing Lewis Elementary School for the 2028–2029 school year, assigning neighborhood K–5 students to Duniway, and also relocating the Communication Behavior classroom services to Duniway. The feeder pathway would be Brentwood Middle School and Cleveland High School.

3. Community/Cluster and District Impact Analysis

3a. Cluster Analysis

How will the proposed closure maintain or improve equity of access to schools offering high quality educational choices?
In the 2026-2027 school year Portland Public Schools staffs and supports 56 elementary programs across the district. Eleven of these programs are situated within K-8 campuses. The enrollment of these programs ranges from 160 students to over 550 students. Using the QEM and our system definition of “well-resourced schools” as a guide, we have established an elementary enrollment of 360 as the minimum threshold to be able to staff and support a comprehensive and stable elementary program. Maximizing the number of sites at or above this minimum threshold allows the district to maximize the number of students who experience grade-level classrooms, comprehensive core enrichments, and targeted academic supports. It also maximizes the number of educators who work full-time on one campus and who benefit from regular collaboration with grade- and content-alike colleagues.

By operating fewer elementary schools and spreading current enrollment more evenly across remaining sites, the district can stabilize and offer a more comprehensive and sustainable program at each elementary site.

In recent years, we have used resources from other parts of our system to subsidize elementary programs with low enrollment. Given our current and projected budget shortfalls, we can no longer sustain subsidies for underenrolled sites. As a result, elementary schools have already faced several programmatic and operational constraints:

- Over half of our elementary programs have been forced to place students in multi-grade classrooms;
- Staffing for instructional coaching, academic coaching, and school climate support positions have been reduced;
- Core enrichment teachers that support Arts, PE, and Library/Media instruction have been split across multiple sites, reducing the capacity to have full-school enrichment programs;
- Support staff that help monitor lunch and recess have been reduced, forcing principals to spend much of their time monitoring duty;
- Opportunities for strong teacher collaboration and professional learning have been compromised by multi-grade classrooms and single-strand programs.

If we continue with no rightsizing action, all of these constraints will be compounded in the 2027-2028 school year.

3b. Effects on Other Schools, Enrollment, and Community Access

The proposed merger would affect Duniway within the Cleveland cluster. Enrollment at Duniway is projected to change from 362 to 533 in the 2028–2029 school year. Based on current enrollment projections, there will be three to four classrooms at each grade level, with blends not required. The combined school community would provide opportunities to stabilize staffing and sustain educational programs and student supports. Duniway would need moderate kitchen upgrades (additional double ovens, dishwasher, warming cooler, and milk cooler), and classroom assignments and student support spaces coordinated to accommodate incoming students while supporting students already enrolled.

Lewis is located approximately 1.2 miles from Duniway. The proposed change would shift students' daily school activities toward Duniway and the Eastmoreland neighborhood. Transportation options include walking, biking, family transportation, and school bus service for eligible students. Potential barriers include longer walking distances and crossings of Campesinos Boulevard and other busy streets, depending on students' home addresses. PPS would support school bus service for students who live more than one mile from the school and work with the school community and the district Safe Routes to School coordinator to identify appropriate crossing, pedestrian, and bicycle safety measures.

3c. Community Partnerships and Potential Community Impact

Lewis does not have Racial Equity & Social Justice (RESJ) partner programming. Closure is not expected to affect RESJ partner services. PPS will continue working with building leaders and school communities at receiving schools so that partnerships reflect what students and families need. Future community use of the facility would be considered through the Building Repurposing process.

Lewis partners with the YMCA to provide child care for approximately 32 students. Relocating Lewis students to Duniway would require families to transition to a different provider, as Duniway partners with Duniway All Stars, which serves approximately 167 students through its school-age and preschool programs. Adding Lewis students could increase enrollment to approximately 199 students, creating additional space and staffing needs. A significant concern is protecting the dedicated space Duniway All Stars uses, as growing classroom needs could result in that space being reassigned for instructional purposes, potentially disrupting services for existing families. We ask that the YMCA, Duniway All Stars, and district leadership be included in early planning discussions to identify child care options for Lewis families, protect existing program space, and determine whether additional appropriately licensed space is available. Any transition plan should consider the needs of both school communities, minimize disruptions for families, and ensure that existing child care services are not compromised by increased enrollment or changing classroom needs.

3d. Operational Plan & Boundary Map

If approved, the closure would take effect in 2028, with students assigned to Duniway Elementary School under the proposed boundaries shown in the attached boundary map.

Operational Implementation Plan

Timeline*	Action
January 2028	Establish school transition teams and school-specific implementation plans. Verify student enrollment. Share principal assignments with communities.
February 2028	Develop staffing plans and confirm initial staff assignments. Identify and prioritize building improvements, equipment, and technology needs.
March 2028	Identify initial classroom assignments and develop school-specific moving schedules, distribute packing supplies, and begin records transfers.
April 2028	Begin packing and sorting materials not needed for daily instruction. Finalize plans for building improvements and technology setup.
May 2028	Confirm summer moving and building-work schedules. Continue packing and prepare materials for transportation and other operational services for receiving schools.
June 2028	Complete teacher packing. Begin school moves after the school year ends and carry out scheduled building improvements.
July 2028	Continue school moves and building improvements. Install furniture, equipment, and technology at receiving schools.
August 2028	Complete scheduled moves by mid August. Finish cleaning, classroom setup, and technology testing.
September 2028	Monitor school operations and address remaining transition needs. Complete closing-building inventories.

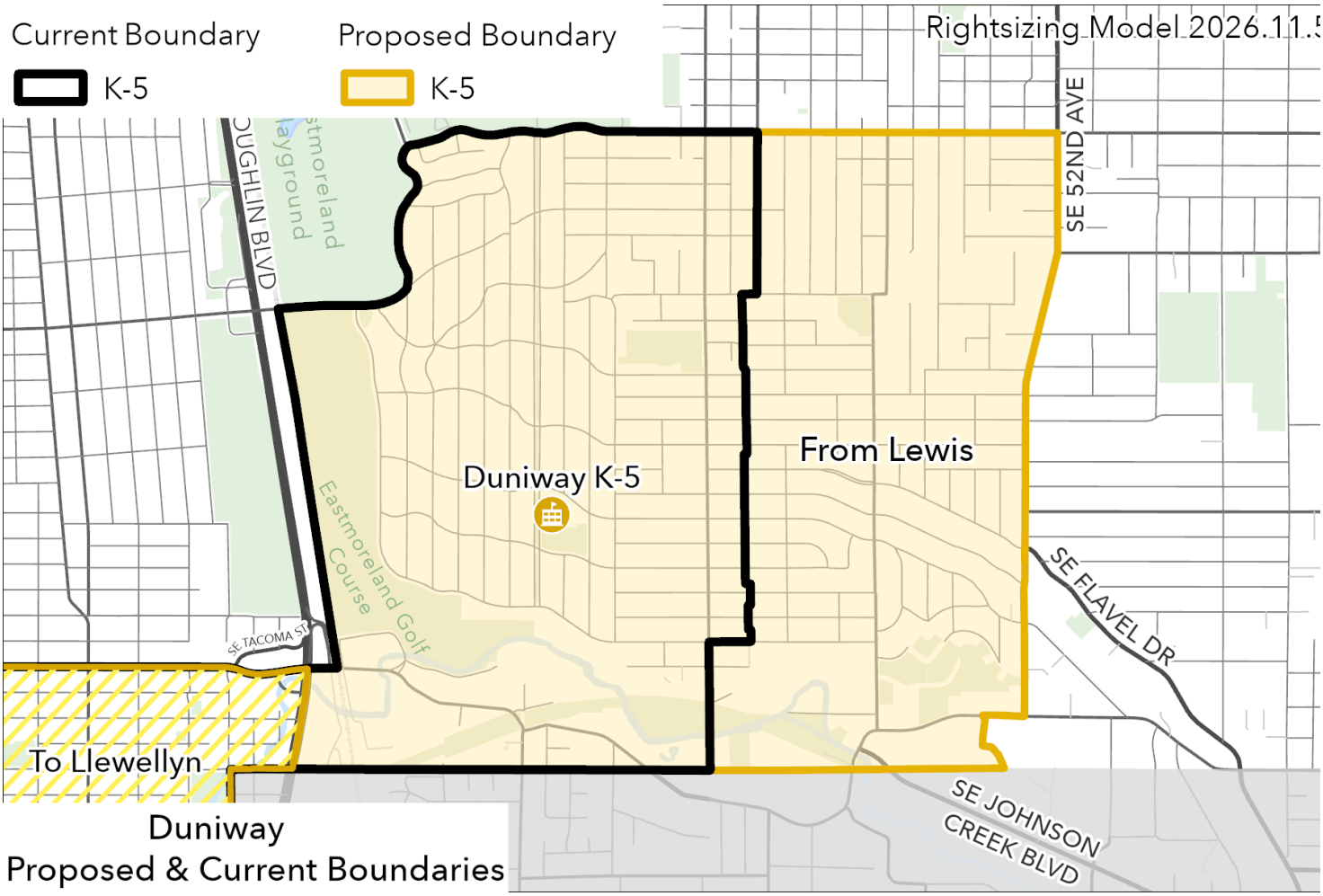
**Subject to change*

Review and Approval

This report has been reviewed by appropriate district staff.

Superintendent Signature

Date



Duniway
Proposed & Current Boundaries